

JavaScript

JavaScript (JS) is a lightweight interpreted (or [just-in-time compiled](#)) programming language with [first-class functions](#). While it is most well-known as the scripting language for Web pages, [many non-browser environments](#) also use it, such as [Node.js](#), [Apache CouchDB](#) and [Adobe Acrobat](#). JavaScript is a [prototype-based](#), [garbage-collected](#), [dynamic](#) language, supporting multiple paradigms such as imperative, functional, and object-oriented.

JavaScript's dynamic capabilities include runtime object construction, variable parameter lists, function variables, dynamic script creation (via `eval`), object introspection (via `for...in` and [Object utilities](#)), and source-code recovery (JavaScript functions store their source text and can be retrieved through `toString()`).

This section is dedicated to the JavaScript language itself, and not the parts that are specific to Web pages or other host environments. For information about [APIs](#) that are specific to Web pages, please see [Web APIs](#) and [DOM](#).

The standards for JavaScript are the [ECMAScript Language Specification](#) (ECMA-262) and the [ECMAScript Internationalization API specification](#) (ECMA-402). As soon as one browser implements a feature, we try to document it. This means that cases where some [proposals for new ECMAScript features](#) have already been implemented in browsers, documentation and examples in MDN articles may use some of those new features. Most of the time, this happens between the [stages](#) 3 and 4, and is usually before the spec is officially published.

Do not confuse JavaScript with the [Java programming language](#) — **JavaScript is not "Interpreted Java"**. Both "Java" and "JavaScript" are trademarks or registered trademarks of Oracle in the U.S. and other countries. However, the two programming languages have very different syntax, semantics, and use.

JavaScript documentation of core language features (pure [ECMAScript](#), for the most part) includes the following:

- The [JavaScript guide](#)
- The [JavaScript reference](#)

For more information about JavaScript specifications and related technologies, see [JavaScript technologies overview](#).

Beginner's tutorials

Our [learn web development core modules](#) contain modern, up-to-date tutorials covering JavaScript fundamentals.

[Your first website: Adding interactivity](#)

This article provides a brief tour of what JavaScript is and how to use it, aimed at people who are completely new to web development.

[Dynamic scripting with JavaScript](#)

This module focuses on the essentials of the core JavaScript language, plus some key surrounding topics — learning these topics will give you a solid basis to work from.

[JavaScript frameworks and libraries](#)

JavaScript frameworks are an essential part of modern front-end web development, providing developers with tried and tested tools for building scalable, interactive web applications. Many modern companies use frameworks as a